



Master stroke: Grandmaster Viswanathan Anand during Gukesh's match against Ding Liren. "Gukesh was rewarded for his perseverance, for his decision to keep trying," says the author. FIDE / MARIA EMELIANOVA

class. His win in Game 12 was especially impressive, showcasing his mental and physical readiness to peak at the right moment. In the end, though, Gukesh had that extra edge — perhaps just enough luck to tip the scales in his favour.

Watching Gukesh's emotional outburst after his victory was heartwarming. We all have our unique ways of celebrating such moments, and I'm sure I did something similar in my own time. It was lovely to see his joy so openly expressed.

As for those questioning the credibility of this World championship, it is something that Gukesh will need to get used to. Once you get to where he has reached, you can't expect just one-way traffic.

There would be constant scrutiny. But the fact remains — he is the youngest World champion in history, and that is a monumental achievement. He should now try to enjoy his chess as much as possible. He's got so much of his life ahead of him, he should enjoy it all the way.



Ding, too, proved himself to be a great champion. However, today, it felt like he somehow wanted the match to end. He appeared hasty to finish things, to exchange pieces quickly, and he got punished for that.